

COMMUNICATION

From unlimited text messaging to video calls that aren't charged by the minute, these apps are integral to the plan of achieving communication nirvana

Many of you reading this may have realized that we're not talking on phones as much as we're typing on them. That's testament to how communication has evolved due to smartphones and their apps. When texting arrived, for many the limiting factor to using that service was the charge incurred per SMS. Then mobile internet happened and we got our favorite instant messengers like Google Talk on our handheld devices. Today, instant messengers like WhatsApp are solely responsible for huge losses of what would have been SMS revenue for mobile phone operators. And it's not just about texting now — phones have been equipped with front-facing cameras since a long time, but it was only when video calls weren't charged by the minute did they become popular. Before the iPhone, typing on touchscreens with a stylus used to be a pain, and heavy typists would swear by their BlackBerrys. But even the most hardcore of thumb-typers are experiencing just how fast it is to type on a virtual QWERTY on a touchscreen, when coupled with the magic of amazing word prediction. We may be oceans apart, but with communication apps, we don't feel the distance.